THE NEW OTTOMAN EMPIRE

Enemy Faction Reference Board

The New Ottomans do the job the Covenant did in Halo 2: a readable enemy ecology where every class has its own silhouette, its own job in the encounter and a predictable break point. Unlike the Covenant they are human, so readability cannot come from alien anatomy. It has to come from equipment, posture, scale and one colour tell per rank. The source is the historical Ottoman army: a professional household corps at the centre, expendable levies in front, and frontier raiders on the flanks.

ROLE MAP

HALO 2	LONG COLT	HISTORICAL ROOT	ENCOUNTER JOB	BREAK POINT
Elite + Brute	**Janissary** Yeniçeri	The sultan's standing household infantry: recruited young, raised inside the corps, among the first infantry built around firearms.	Leader and line-holder. Heavy rifle, brutal close-range blade. Anchors every squad.	Armour spalls in stages, exposing the cyborg frame. Kill the Çorbacı and the rest charge.
Grunt	**Azab** Azap	Conscripted front-line infantry who took the first charge, then fell back to the flanks so guns and Janissaries could fire.	Numbers. A bladed line that screens the Janissaries, volleys, then peels to the flanks.	Light armour, thin morale. Kill the Bölükbaşı and the squad falls back.
Jackal	**Akinji** Akıncı	Frontier light cavalry: raiders, scouts and advance guard who lived off what they took.	Flankers, scouts and marksmen. Fast, fragile, opportunistic.	Never hold ground. Pressure them and they withdraw, then circle back from another angle.

1. The Porte: faction design language
2. Janissary
3. Azab
4. Akinji
5. Lineup & encounter grammar
6. Synthesis: palette, materials, sound

Silhouettes on these pages are original Long Colt proposals drawn for this board, not traced from any source. References are linked rather than embedded; open them for the imagery. Unit names are the historical Ottoman terms, used here as in-world corps names.

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1. The Porte: Faction Design Language

PREMISE (PROPOSED)

A breakaway human power ruled from a fortified capital world, built around a professional household army. Its loyalty is dynastic and institutional: to the throne and to the corps. Its soldiers are not fanatics or monsters. They are disciplined, well-drilled and confident, which is what makes them frightening. Like the Covenant, they should feel like an old, ordered civilisation with its own ceremony, not a raider rabble.

CONTRAST WITH THE PLAYER

	LONG COLT MARINES	NEW OTTOMAN
Form	Slabs, boxes, squared plates	Cones, domes and ribbed curves. Every helmet starts from the chichak cone.
Finish	Matte olive, tape, mud	Lacquered gunmetal and oxblood. Gilt is earned: only officers carry it.
Ornament	Stencils, tallies, names	One engraved band on a plate edge, never all-over texture. Bands read as rank at 20 m and vanish at 50 m.
Light	Practical only, no glow	One emissive cue: turquoise sensor slits. The faction's tell in rain and dark.
Sound	Radio static, clipped chatter	Mehter: kettle drums, bass drum, zurna and cymbals, carried on loudspeakers as an advance cue.

MOTIF SOURCES

Chichak helmet: cone, sliding nasal, cheek plates and neck guard. The base shape for all three classes.

Tombak: gilded copper alloy unique to Ottoman workshops, used on ceremonial helmets and shields. The rank metal.

Kalkan: domed cane-and-silk shield with an iron boss, woven in tight geometric patterns. Source for the faction's woven and quilted textures.

The börk: tall felt Janissary hat with a front holder for a spoon. Becomes the Janissary head-crest and sensor socket.

The kazan: the corps' cooking cauldron, a unit symbol in the historical orta. Use as the squad standard painted on Janissary plate.

Iznik tile palette: cobalt, turquoise, oxblood on white. Source of the faction's colour.

HANDLING THE REAL-WORLD SOURCE

The Ottoman name and corps titles carry real national and religious identity, and the player kit is drawn from GWOT-era Marines. Without care the pairing reads as a modern war on Turks or Muslims rather than an original sci-fi empire.

Keep it imperial, not religious. Draw from military institutions, arms and armour, court ceremony and tile and textile pattern. Leave out mosques, scripture, prayer and religious script.

Invent the emblems. A state seal in the spirit of the tughra, the corps cauldron, rank bands. Not the historical flag.

Give them a point of view. Halo 2's Arbiter levels are the precedent: the campaign hits harder when the enemy has reasons, rank and grief of its own.

Helmet, Ottoman, ca. 1580, steel and copper alloy (The Met 14.25.534)

Ceremonial helmet, Ottoman, late 16th c., tombak (The Met)

Helmet simulating overlapping plates, Ottoman, early 17th c., tombak (The Met 1995.68)

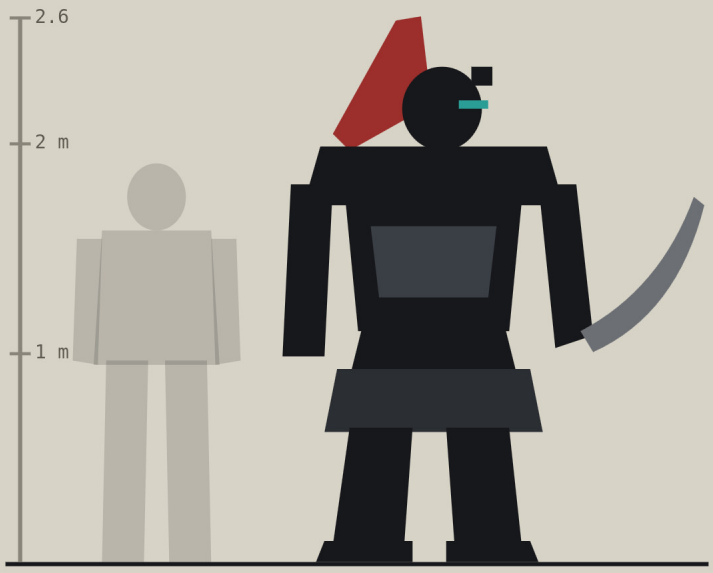
Shield (kalkan), 17th c., cane, silk, iron boss (Royal Armouries XXVIA.126)

Gentile Bellini, seated Janissary, pen and ink, ca. 1479–81 (British Museum)

Janissary (Wikipedia) · Ottoman military band (Wikipedia)

2. Janissary

YENIÇERI · ARMOURED CYBORG CORPS · ~2.6 M



Proposal, Nefer rank. Ghost: Long Colt Marine in armour, ~1.9 m. Crest trails back like the börk's felt flap; the stub on the brow is the spoon-holder reborn as a sensor and command mast.

THE FANTASY

Taken young from conquered worlds and raised inside the corps, rebuilt piece by piece into armoured cyborgs. They eat, sleep and fight as one orta. Ceremonial and composed in full plate; brutal once the armour is off.

BODY & KIT

Frame: human torso inside a load-bearing exoskeleton. Shoulders and forearms carry the hydraulics, so the mass sits high and wide.

Plate: lacquered gunmetal over a mail-and-plate skirt at the hips. Officers add tombak-gilt chest plates.

Weapons: long-barrelled heavy rifle (the tüfek), and a forward-curved yatağan vibro-blade. The blade comes out only up close; a rising hum is the warning, never a glow.

DAMAGE STATES

No energy shield. Armour comes off in readable pieces.

1. Full plate. Rounds spark and whine off it.
2. Crest and pauldrons spall away. Silhouette shrinks; player sees progress.
3. Exposed frame, hydraulic lines venting. Faster, reckless, closes for melee.

RANK TIERS: CREST COLOUR IS THE TELL

Nefer
Line trooper. Oxblood crest, bare gunmetal.

Odabaşı
Barracks chief. Ochre crest, one gilt band.

Çorbacı
Commands an orta. White felt crest, gilt chest. Squad leader; his death triggers the charge.

Ağa
Corps commander. Full tombak plate, tall plume. Boss tier; campaign only.

Dark → mid → light → metal: legible by lightness alone, even through rain.

TAKE

Parade-ground posture: upright, chest out, weapon held with ceremony. Mass in the shoulders where the hydraulics sit. Chichak cone helmet, aventail at the neck. Plates that look like they bolt on and fall off.

AVOID

Alien anatomy or mandibles. Robes and turbans over armour. All-over arabesque texture. Gold on every rank. Glowing blades. Anything that reads as a mech with no person inside.

Ottoman helmet ca. 1580: cone, nasal, cheek and neck guards (The Met)

Ottoman tombak helmet simulating overlapping plates (The Met 1995.68)

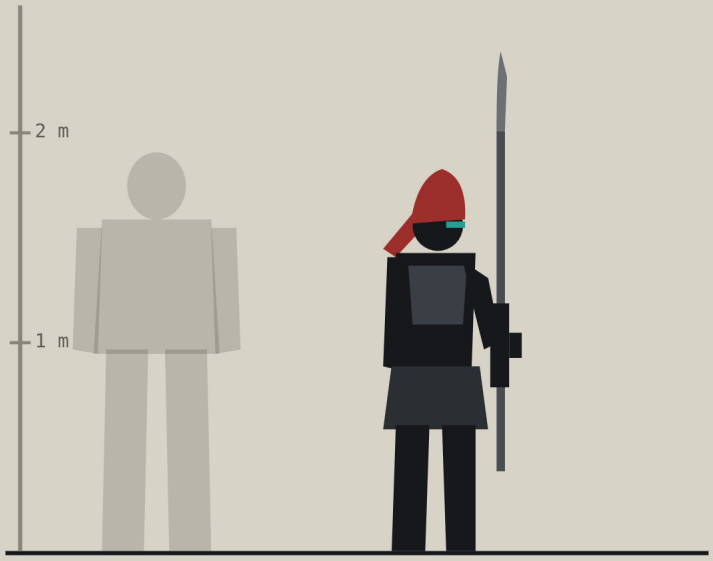
Gentile Bellini, seated Janissary in tall börk (British Museum)

Sarcos Guardian XO full-body exoskeleton: real-world load-bearing frame (Robots Guide)

Janissary: recruitment, orta and ranks, firearms, 1826 abolition (Wikipedia)

3. Azab

AZAP · CONSCRIPT LINE INFANTRY · ~1.75 M



Proposal, line Azab. An ordinary young man in cheap kit: open-faced cone helmet under a red felt cover, quilted coat, one stamped chest plate. The long blade on the rifle carries on the pole-arms the historical azabs fought with.

THE FANTASY

The historical azabs were levies of young unmarried men, sent in front of the army. Here they are conscripts from subject worlds: unaugmented, lightly armoured, drilled just enough to hold a line. They come in numbers, and they look like what they are: kids in issued kit, shorter and slighter than the armoured Marines they face.

BODY & KIT

Head: open-faced cone helmet with a nasal bar, a red felt cover pulled over it with the flap hanging behind. The historical azabs wore red börks; the red cap is the class tell.

Body: quilted coat to mid-thigh, belted, one stamped plate on the chest. Nothing on the arms. Same issue on every man, so a squad reads as a unit.

Weapon: a long rifle with a glaive-length blade fixed under the barrel. In a packed line the blades stand up above the caps: a forest of steel that reads at any distance.

BEHAVIOUR FROM HISTORY

Azabs fought at the front, took the enemy's first charge, then withdrew to the flanks so the guns and Janissaries behind them could fire. They advance in a loose line, volley, and peel away on a horn signal to uncover the Janissary gunline. Morale is thin: lose their officer and they fall back.

TIERS

Azab

Line conscript. Red cap, bladed rifle. Fights in groups of four to six.

Okçu

"Archer." The azabs began as bowmen; these carry a lobbing grenade launcher and fire in volleys from behind the line. Cobalt cap.

Bölükbaşı

Squad head. Ochre cap, signal horn on the chest. Calls the advance and the withdrawal.

TAKE

Historical infantry kit: felt caps, quilted coats, pole-arms. GWOT-era conscript armies for the issued, ill-fitting look. Line and volley drill as their body language.

AVOID

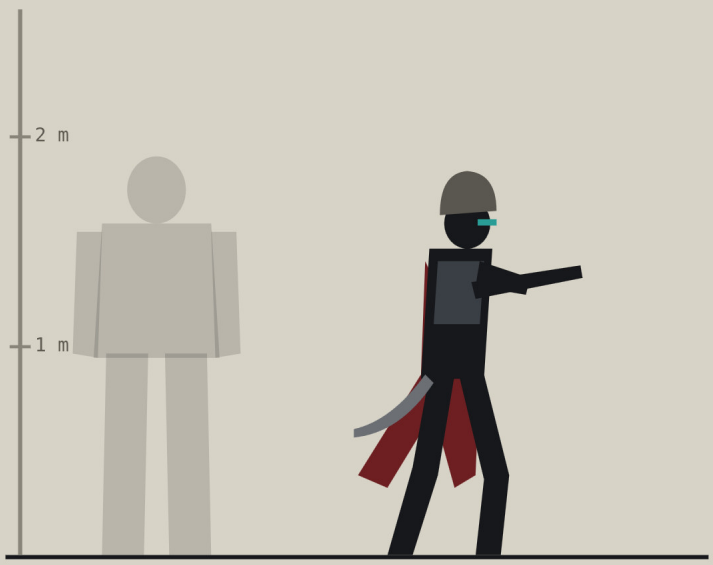
Backpacks, tanks or anything that turns them into a comic shape. Heavy armour. Full face masks; let the open helmet show they are young. Anything that competes with the Janissary for the eye.

Azeb / azab: young levies, front-line role, pole-arms, bows, red börk (Wikipedia)

Ottoman helmet ca. 1580: cone, nasal, cheek and neck guards (The Met)

4. Akinji

AKINCI · FRONTIER RAIDERS AND SCOUTS · ~1.8 M



Proposal, Akinji raider on the move. Slightly shorter than an armoured Marine and much lighter: fur cap, mail shirt, split riding coat flaring behind, short carbine, curved sabre at the hip.

THE FANTASY

The historical akıncı were irregular light cavalry on the frontier: raiders, scouts and advance troops who lived off what they took. Here they ride ahead of the empire in fast raider craft and fight on foot once they land. Hunters, not soldiers: lightly kitted, quick, patient, and gone before you can pin them down. They are the first enemy the player sees and the ones who strip the dead afterwards.

BODY & KIT

Head: fur-trimmed cap over a light skullcap helmet. Often a scarf or a looted Marine goggle strap.

Body: mail or lamellar shirt over padding; a long riding coat split front and back, which flares when they run. Riding boots, wraps at the shin.

Weapons: short carbine (a horseman's gun) or a long marksman rifle; a curved sabre for close work. Kit is looted and mismatched: Long Colt webbing on an Akinji tells the player whose patrol didn't come back.

BEHAVIOUR FROM HISTORY

Raiders, not line troops. They harass, flank and withdraw rather than hold ground, scout ahead of the Janissaries, and pick off stragglers. In a fight they are always moving between cover, running low.

TIERS: COAT COLOUR

Akinji

Raider. Oxblood coat, carbine and sabre. Works in pairs on the flanks.

Marksman

Cobalt coat, long rifle, takes high ground and stays there. Scope glint before each shot.

Akıncı Beyi

Raid leader. Pale coat, taller fur cap with a plume, trophy kit on the belt.

TAKE

Steppe and frontier horsemen's dress: fur caps, mail, long split coats, curved sabres. Modern light recon and special-reconnaissance teams for the scavenged, layered kit.

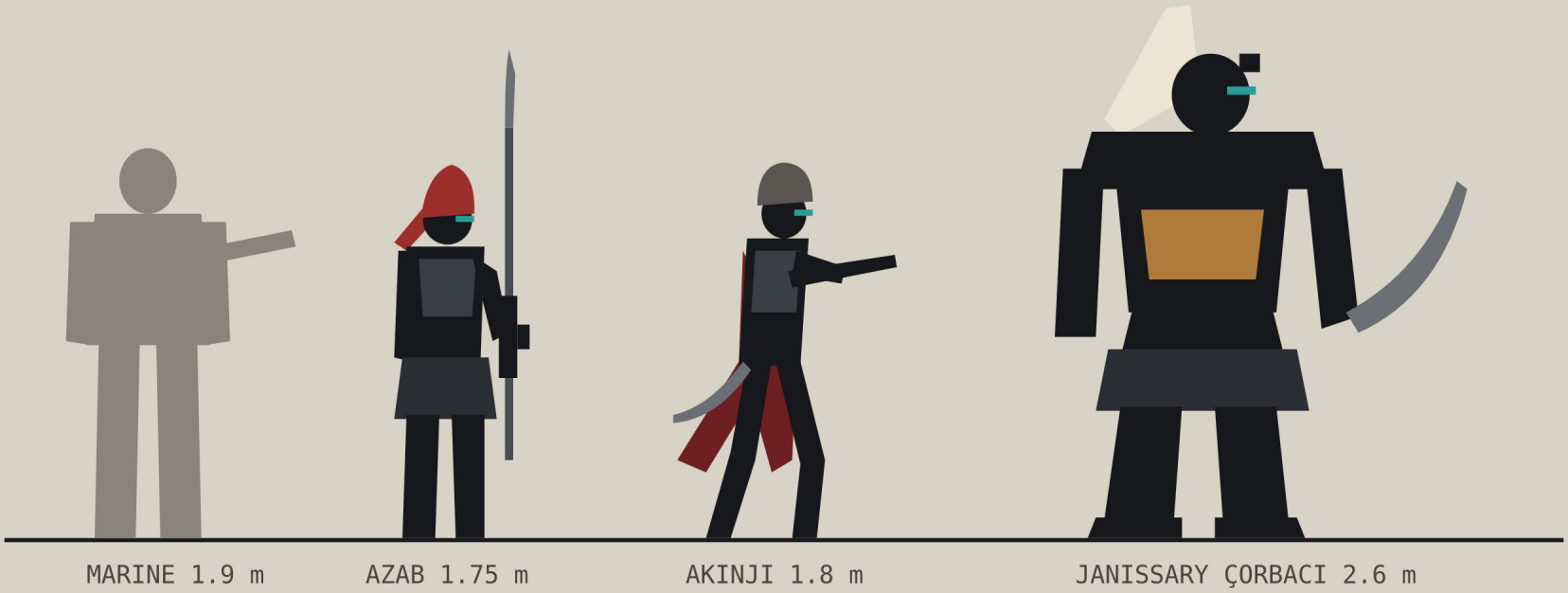
AVOID

Shields. Alien posture or stilt legs. Horses in Phase 0. Desert-bandit costume: no eyes-only face wraps, no bandoliers over robes.

Akinji: irregular raiders, scouts and advance troops (Wikipedia)

The military organization of the akıncıs in Ottoman Rumelia (Bilkent University thesis)

5. Lineup & Encounter Grammar



True relative scale. Conscripts and raiders are ordinary men, a little shorter and much lighter than an armoured Marine. Only the Janissary is bigger than the player.

READABILITY RULES

Black-fill test. Every class must be named correctly from a solid black silhouette at 50 m. Upright blade above a red cap, a flaring coat under a fur cap, a crest over massive shoulders.

One colour per rank. Rank lives only on the crest, cap or shield face. Everything else stays gunmetal.

Turquoise means enemy. Every New Ottoman carries a turquoise sensor slit. Nothing the player owns uses that hue.

Sound before sight. Mehter drums for an advancing orta, the Bölükbaşı's horn for the Azab line, scope glint for an Akinji marksman.

THE ORTA ENCOUNTER

Historical Ottoman battle order turned into a combat loop, laid onto Forward Outpost 7.

SCREEN	4–6 Azabs and a Bölükbaşı push across the courtyard and draw the player's fire.
PEEL	After losses the Azabs fall back to the flanks, revealing two Nefers and a Çorbacı firing from the command platform.
FLANK	An Akinji pair runs the catwalks to flank; a marksman takes the overwatch perch.
BREAK	Kill the Çorbacı: Azabs rout, surviving Janissaries draw blades and charge. The player's skill moment.

Azab front-line screen and withdrawal to the flanks (Wikipedia)

Mehter: kös, davul, zurna, zil and the Janissary band (Wikipedia)

6. Synthesis: New Ottoman Opposing Force

Proposed palette (not sourced)

Gunmetal / base plate	#23262b	#3a3f46	#5a616b	#8a9099
Oxblood / lacquer, crests	#3d1416	#6e1f22	#9c2f2c	#c4553e
Iznik cobalt / turquoise	#1d2f5e	#2f4f9a	#2a9d97 sensor	#6cc3bd
Tombak / felt / rank	#5e3a1c	#b07a3a	#c98a2e	#ece4d4

Tombak is a coppery gilt, deliberately redder than the player's gold visor (#e0b04a) so the two never read as the same team. Long Colt olive appears nowhere on the enemy.

SILHOUETTE

Three body plans the player names in a glance: upright with a blade standing over a red cap (Azab), low and running with a coat flaring behind (Akinji), towering with a trailing crest (Janissary). Two are ordinary men; the third is a machine with a man inside.

MATERIALS

Lacquered steel that chips to bright metal, never to primer. Mail and quilted fabric at joints. Tombak only on officers. Quilted coats and felt on Azabs; mail, fur and worn leather on Akinji.

WEAR

A garrison army, not a field army. Janissary plate is kept polished, which makes every scorch and dent from the player read. Azab kit is patched and reissued. Akinji kit is looted and layered.

SOUND

The Marines have radio static; the Porte has the mehter. Kettle drum and bass drum for an orta on the move, zurna as the attack signal, cymbal crashes on a Çorbacı's order. Distorted through outpost loudspeakers, it sits under the rain.

PER INFLUENCE

Halo 2: the three-role split and nothing more. Ottoman army: corps structure, battle order, helmets, dress, weapons, ranks, music. Exoskeleton engineering: the Janissary frame. Iznik ceramics: palette.

AVOID

Alien or monster anatomy. Religious imagery or script. Gold everywhere. Glow beyond the sensor slit. Fantasy-Orientalist costume. Covenant purple and swooping organic forms: this is a human industrial empire.

PHASE 0 BUILD LIST: FORWARD OUTPOST 7

Basic AI and a tiny scope mean one orta, greyboxed first: 4 Azab + 1 Bölükbaşı, 2 Akinji (1 raider, 1 marksman), 2 Nefer + 1 Çorbacı. Five meshes covers it: Azab, Akinji, Janissary, the bladed rifle and the yatağan. Rank variants are material swaps on the crest, cap and coat, which keeps the solo art budget honest.

Palette, silhouettes and lore premise are proposals for Long Colt, not taken from any source.